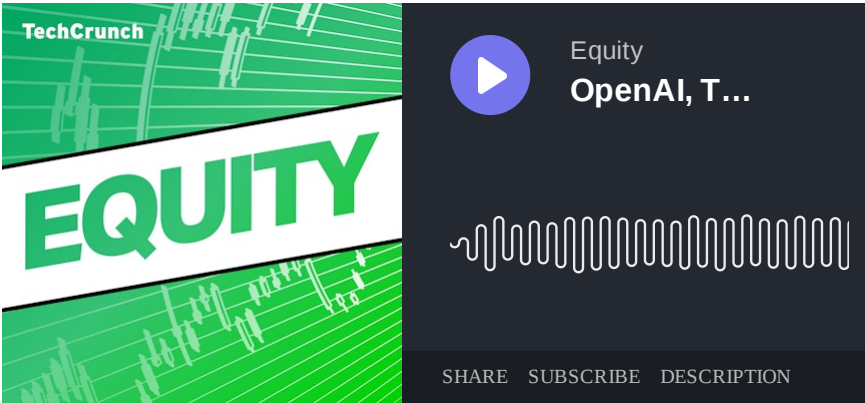


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OpenAI, Thinking Machines Lab, and the built-in chaos of a \$2B seed round

Theresa Loconsolo, Kirsten Korosec, Rebecca Bellan, Anthony Ha — Jul 18, 2025

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OpenAI’s former chief technology officer, Mira Murati, just raised [one of the largest seed rounds in history](#). Murati secured \$2 billion in that seed round for Thinking Machines Lab — a startup so early, it hasn’t even revealed what it’s working on yet. The move is raising eyebrows across Silicon Valley, and it’s only the latest in a wave of top researchers splintering off from OpenAI to chase [their own AI moonshots](#).

Today, on TechCrunch’s [Equity](#) podcast, hosts Kirsten Korosec, Rebecca Bellan and Anthony Ha break down what’s fueling the OpenAI talent shuffle, investor enthusiasm, and [a former employee’s behind-the-scenes peek](#) inside the company. Either way, the team agrees: seed rounds really have changed.

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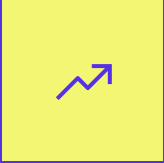
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- The AI coding assistant sector is heating up with major acquisitions. [Devin-maker Cognition acquired Windsurf](#) just days after Google poached the latter's leadership in what's becoming a pattern of reverse acquihires
- And Jack Dorsey's latest string of [vibe-coding projects](#) and [nonprofit hacker collective](#), all pointing back to his long-standing push for decentralized tech

Equity will be back for you next week, so don't miss it!

Equity is TechCrunch's flagship podcast, produced by Theresa Loconsolo, and posts every Wednesday and Friday.

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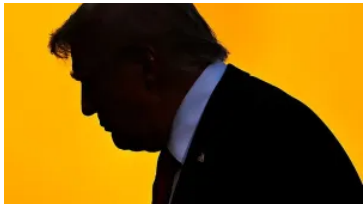
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